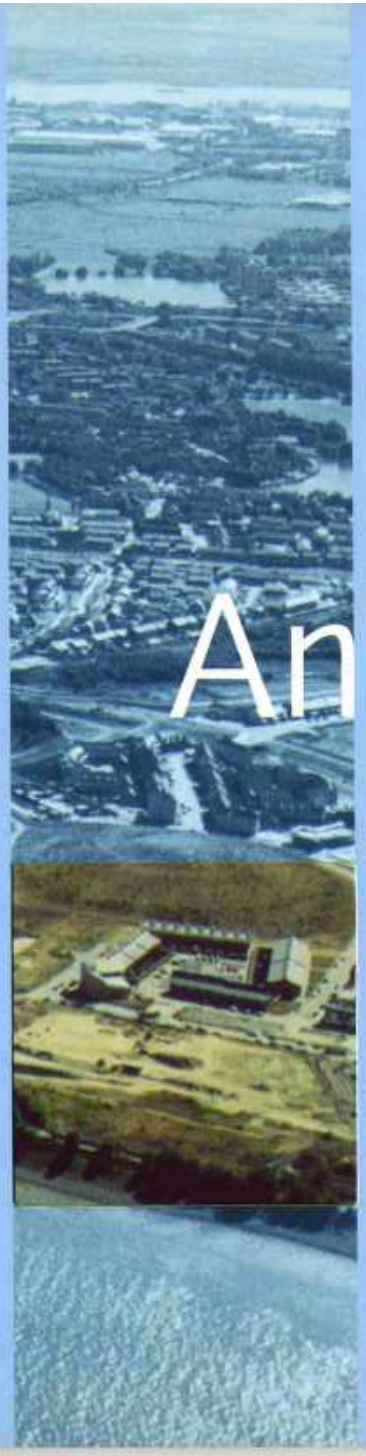


GALLIONS
HOUSING
ASSOCIATION

Annual Review 2002/03



Key Corporate Objectives

Objective 1:
To have in place robust governance that enables the delivery of a comprehensive set of strategies for the proper running of the business.

Objective 2:
To adopt a financial and investment strategy based on a careful assessment of risk, to ensure our long-term financial viability.

Objective 3:
To provide or facilitate the provision of a range of high quality services that are good value to customers and where possible offer choice.

Objective 4:
To effectively manage our assets to provide good quality, decent homes for existing and future residents.

Objective 5:
To create a sustainable and mixed community which facilitates a quality of life and a place of choice for existing and future residents and in particular to regenerate Tavy Bridge.

Objective 6:
To increase the provision of homes, services and products in existing and new areas for a wide-ranging client group.

Objective 7:
To establish our position in the sector as an innovative and customer-focused organisation.

Objective 8:
To maximise opportunities for sustaining and protecting the environment.

Objective 9:
To improve community safety, working in partnership with other key agencies.

Chair's Statement



It is with great pleasure that I welcome you to our third annual review. It has been an extremely challenging year for the Association and particularly for the Board. Nevertheless, demonstrable progress has been achieved and we are much stronger as a result.

I am extremely proud and pleased with the way the Board, Executive Team and Managers have worked closely together to achieve this progress. There has been a clear understanding and recognition of our particular roles in driving the organisation forward. The changes we have achieved mean that Gallions is now firmly established, recognised and respected. We can now move forward with renewed confidence.

I am exceedingly grateful for the co-operation and dedication of my Board colleagues, the Executive Team and staff and for their enormous efforts in the past year.

Graham Horton

Chair

Chief Executive's Statement



Welcome to our third Annual Review. I would like to start by thanking our Chair, Graham Horton, for his tremendous contribution over the last year. Graham picked up the challenge in unexpected circumstances and has been vital in steering us through some potentially very difficult waters. I know the rest of the Board and my colleagues join me in paying tribute to him.

Graham and the Board have provided a clear vision and identified a set of key objectives against which we can measure progress. Together we have developed a clear and concise Business Plan which sets out how we aim to develop over the coming years.

The timing of this coincided perfectly with the announcement of the Government's Sustainable Communities Plan. This strategic framework reflects our own vision for our work in Thamesmead as described over the following pages.

The neighbourhood focus of our activities demonstrates our commitment to developing sustainable communities. The range of activities explained in this review shows that we are much more than just a landlord. We offer a range of skills and work with an increasing number of agencies.

We are strategically placed in the Thames Gateway, financially robust, confident about our role and purpose, proud of our partnership-based approach and optimistic that we can play a key part in delivering sustainable communities.

Tony Cotter

Chief Executive

Thamesmead's Time

This is an exciting time for Thamesmead and Gallions. The recent Government Sustainable Communities Plan, focusing on the development of the Thames Gateway as an answer to housing shortages in London, has put Thamesmead back at the top of the development agenda.

Gallions' experience of regeneration, community investment and environmental management will help us make the most of the Government's new plans.

We believe that communities are more than just housing. Gallions' history in Thamesmead and our commitment to the Thamesmead community has given us experience of managing responsibilities far wider than any traditional landlord. We look after lakes, canals, public parks, open spaces, highways and a wide range of community facilities such as local shops and leisure activities.

Our joint work with local statutory bodies to introduce schemes such as the Neighbourhood Wardens has increased public perception of Thamesmead as a place of choice, and brought benefits to our tenants.

We are working towards making Thamesmead a truly sustainable community, developing an economic, social and environmental infrastructure that will create a community where people can live, work and relax.

Thamesmead was the first vision for a whole new community in the Thames Gateway but it was left unfinished. Now is a great opportunity to finish the work started by the GLC and demonstrate what the Sustainable Communities Plan will mean to the Gateway and Thamesmead.





Gallions has eleven organisational values that underpin all of its activities:

- Integrity and openness
- Customer focus
- Being a good employer
- Partnership working
- Working with residents
- Community safety
- Equality and diversity
- Innovation & continual improvement
- Environmental sustainability
- Socially responsible
- Financial viability

Gateway to the Future

The Sustainable Communities Plan forecasts that as a result of significant economic and social investment by 2031 the Thames Gateway will be a thriving community, with an additional 200,000 homes, 300,000 new jobs and more infrastructure. Gallions will be a central player in these initiatives.

Our property ownership in Thamesmead makes us one of three associations with the largest presence in the Thames Gateway. This substantial position, combined with a track record of meeting the kind of objectives set down in the Sustainable Communities Plan, makes us and Thamesmead the natural choice for agencies looking for partners in the Gateway. Our position now gives us many opportunities for growth within and around Thamesmead.

Forward thinking

Our work with European housing associations has enabled us to bring innovative methods of building from the continent to the UK. Our 'Ecopark' is a development of 39 houses modelled on a Dutch system of sustainable construction methods using environmentally friendly materials to achieve reductions in energy consumption and costs for the occupier.

Successful developer

Gallions has a strong development programme with 500 housing units in the pipeline and another 500 planned. After only one year as a housing association we have been successful in attracting Housing Corporation grants for new build developments. This is unusual and demonstrates the confidence that exists in our ability to deliver. Our future plans for Thamesmead include developing a wider mix of tenures, and with the houses in our first shared ownership scheme all selling within two weeks, the future looks bright. We have a further 80 units of shared ownership development planned for the next two years.

Regeneration expertise

Phase one of our plans to regenerate old Thamesmead is now very much under way at Tavy Bridge. Comprising some of the worst design features of the 1960's, Tavy Bridge currently includes 326 homes, a shopping area at first floor level and an unattractive parking area at ground level. The project will be completed in six to eight years and will provide 450 additional new homes covering an area of 5 hectares.

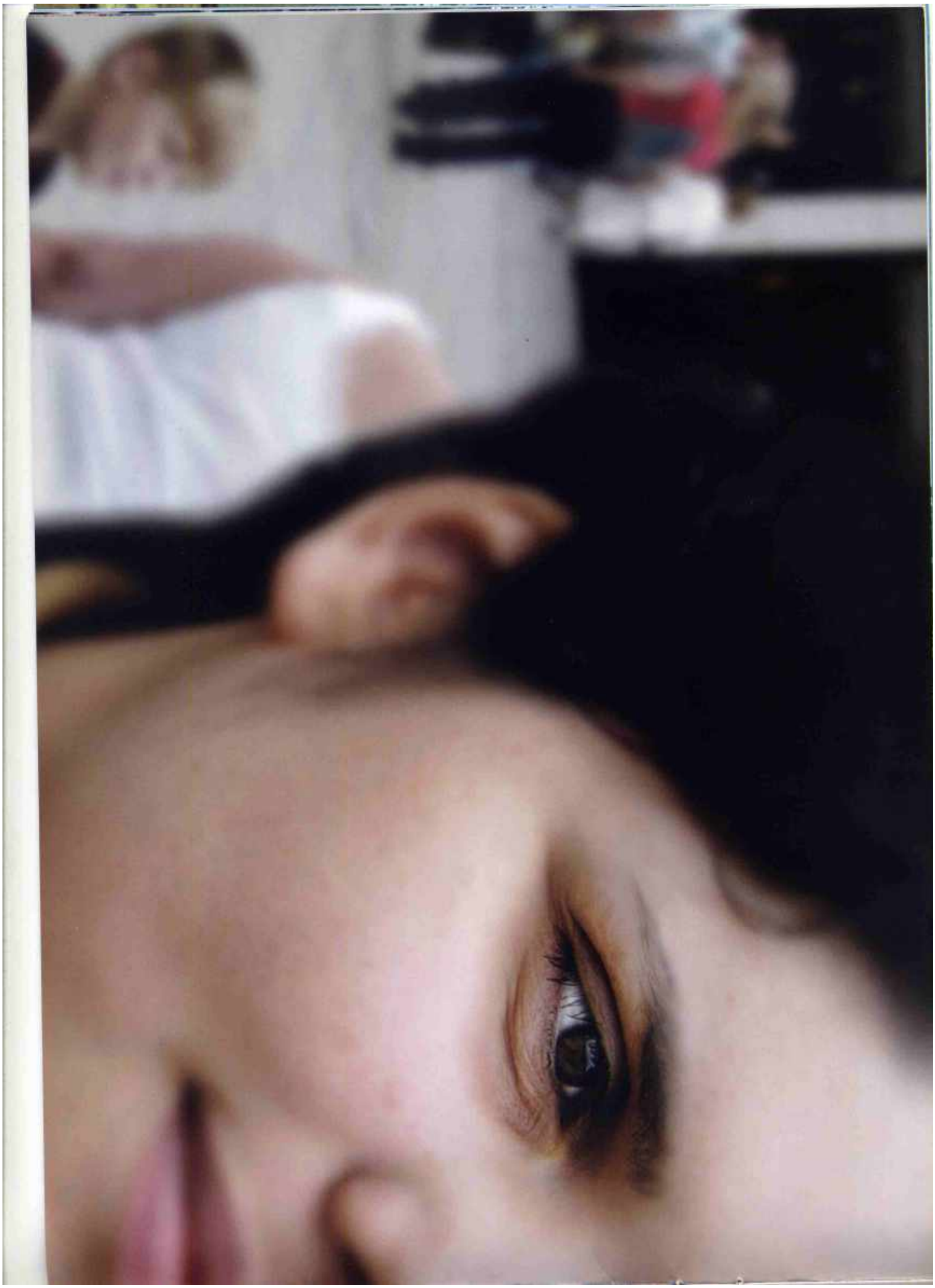
Flexible thinking and planning

Gallions is exploring the possibility of bringing the Dutch social housing quality accreditation scheme, KWH, to the UK. Together with our partner organisations we have applied for a grant from the Housing Corporation to explore the potential for applying KWH in the UK.

Better customer service

We spend over two million pounds each year maintaining our stock, and we have just entered into an agreement with maintenance firm Axis Europe plc. After only six months of operation, cost savings have been achieved, customer service satisfaction has increased and streamlined work practices have been put into place.





Creating the Vision

Building Local Strategic Partnerships is at the heart of the Government's Sustainable Communities Plan, and with our own experience in partnership development, we are well placed to help make the Gateway vision a reality.

Partnership working is a key organisational value for us. In our short three-year existence we have already built a reputation as an organisation that works well in partnership with other agencies. We are keen to build both business and community partnerships across a broad spectrum of projects. We have learned how working in partnership with others can bring added benefit to the community. Our partnerships are built on mutual respect and a genuine desire to achieve. We are often complimented by those who work with us on our flexible 'can do' and practical approach.

Community Safety

The past twelve months have been an exciting time for community safety in Thamesmead. This year has seen the development of a dedicated Community Safety team to deliver a broader range of community based activities. Considerable headway has been made in forging partnerships with local boroughs and other agencies to tackle the issues that most affect residents.

This partnership working has resulted in practical initiatives such as Cubit – a joint approach to tackling abandoned and dangerous vehicles – and even more importantly trust and confidence and collaboration at an operational level. Our office staff, Team Gallions staff and Neighbourhood Wardens receive regular briefings from the police and we work closely together to improve community safety and public confidence and reduce criminal activities.

Neighbourhood Wardens

Our Wardens regularly patrol the streets of Abbey Wood and Thamesmead, working towards reducing criminal activity and helping the community feel safer in and around their homes. Managed by a Gallions-employed Project Manager, the Wardens comprise both Gallions and Greenwich Council staff. Their work is overseen by a committee whose membership includes Greenwich Council, the Metropolitan Police and Gallions.

Sharing responsibilities

Greenwich Council and Gallions have worked together to achieve consistent standards across land ownerships in Thamesmead. We supply maintenance equipment and staff to each other and have agreed to maintain defined areas regardless of legal ownership.

Managing the environment

The Thamesmead, Abbey Wood and Plumstead Community Safety and Environment Management Partnership brings together representatives from all key agencies working in Thamesmead and neighbouring areas to co-ordinate and manage community safety and reduce enviro-crime.

Police patrol bikes

We secured funding to buy three all-terrain motorcycles and funded an intensive three- week training course for four police officers. These bikes patrol Thamesmead and have exceeded all targets for arrests and reduction of motorcycle nuisance.

Cross-borough policing

In the past Thamesmead's policing has suffered from a cross-borough divide. Through our work with Bexleyheath and Greenwich Metropolitan Police, we have achieved a unique solution for policing Thamesmead. Bexleyheath now seconds two officers to Greenwich who work from a joint police station in Thamesmead under the management of a Greenwich Inspector.




Food Angels
Hey!
Noodles

Delivering More for Life

Listening to our customers is important to us. By reviewing our maintenance and repairs service this year, we have ensured that it has remained customer focused and of a consistently high standard.

We continue to build on our early commitment to customer service. In April the Customer Response Centre was launched, with a freephone number. The CRC takes 2,000 calls per week – a good indication of its success. In October we embarked on a Partnering Contract for day-to-day repairs. In close consultation with the Gallions Residents Board, we appointed maintenance firm Axis Europe plc for the next 10 years. We also appointed a Quality Manager to ensure success. She has developed a productive working relationship with Axis and drives achievement of the partnering charter.

This has already proved cost effective and offers the following innovative features and benefits:

- Resident appointments with new two-hour time slots, so customers can plan their day without worrying about missing contractors when they call
- Pre-inspections carried out by Axis to avoid excessive visits from Gallions and Axis staff before the work is done
- Customer satisfaction monitoring – so far the percentage of satisfied customers is in excess of 90%
- Residents' forums and tenants' surgeries to discuss the service
- An average turnaround time for empty properties of 3.5 weeks

Working closely with Axis we have created a charter which outlines the partnership's objectives and sets out performance measures that are reviewed monthly. We check on:

- Jobs completed on time
- Quality of repairs
- Appointments made and kept
- Jobs completed on the first visit

Creating jobs for the community

We are working closely with Axis to promote workforce development in the local area, ensuring that there is a good proportion of local labour employed on the contract. Equally importantly, the proportion of black and minority ethnic workers in Axis' team is also monitored to ensure it mirrors the Thamesmead community.

Gallions and Axis are also working together to support local community initiatives. We recently funded football training for Chinese and Vietnamese children at Charlton Football Club, and Axis have provided the labour and materials for a crèche for our Residents' Resource Centre.





Placing People First

Gallions continues to promote a welcoming, vibrant, confident and diverse community in Thamesmead where there is mutual respect for background, race, religion and culture.

Gallions manages a diverse community in Thamesmead, 20 per cent of which is black and minority ethnic. In 2002 we produced our strategy for equality and diversity for Gallions in response to the Race and Housing Inquiry's Challenge Report and the subsequent Race and Equality Code of Practice for Housing Associations.

Our strategy called 'Living Together' is a practical document that will is being used to shape our services and activities.

An Equality and Diversity Panel (EaDiP) was set up to monitor the strategy and to look at all aspects of equality and diversity for the residents of Thamesmead. EaDiP is chaired by the Board Champion for Equality and Diversity, Tokky Ademoyero, also a Gallions' tenant and has a wide membership drawn from local BME community leaders, Gallions' staff, local police, community groups and other agencies serving equality issues and minority groups in the local area.

Over the year, EaDiP members have helped promote, and participated in, a number of events promoting equality in the local area, including:

- An Asian Mela
- A Chinese New Year Celebration
- The Respect Festival at the Millennium Dome
- A Vietnamese children's football training programme

EaDiP is now looking at other equality issues such as disability.

Gallions Residents' Board

The Gallions Residents' Board (GRB) continues to be an important source of ideas and opinions. Over the year it has been consulted on a number of issues, including the Neighbourhood Wardens project, the draft of the tenant's handbook, the Gallions business plan, Living Together and the selection of new maintenance contractor Axis Europe PLC.

GRB is continually reviewing its practices, ensuring it moves with the needs of the tenants and leaseholders it represents. This year it started to review its own constitution, and held the first GRB elections with 24 places and 30 people standing. After the election the GRB went through a training skills audit and is now following a rolling programme of training for the year.

The highlights of the GRB's year included the following:

- Encouraging local youths to attend meetings and discuss issues relevant to them
- The GRB Monitoring Group was set up to monitor and review our service delivery
- Expansion of the Tenants Resource Centre with a number of new groups starting to use it
- The third annual 'Housing Fayre' fun day was held in September, allowing consultation and informed interaction between residents and Gallions staff. 700 residents attended, exceeding all expectations and demonstrating the success of our work to engage with local people
- A review of the funding arrangements for Tenants and Residents Associations to ensure Associations with a high level of activity received larger grants
- Grants were given to the Neighbourhood Wardens (mini wardens) and the Thamesmead under-11 football team
- Introduction of Neighbourhood Forums and training for the tenant Chairs to ensure good information flows between the GRB members and tenants
- Transport for London visited the GRB to update the members on plans for transport in the area over the next five years

GRB
GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD

ENGLAND
ENGLAND

Creating Opportunities

Our goal is to encourage people to remain living in Thamesmead because they have access to all the facilities they require, because they get support from their neighbours and because they feel safe and comfortable in their homes.

Our Community Renewal Team was established in 2001, and since then we have developed a community strategy to help us ensure that Thamesmead is a place where people enjoy living and working. Working with Renaisi, a specialist external agency, we have run a series of consultation events and a community survey to identify residents' needs and aspirations.

Community Chest

The Community Chest provides small grants of up to £500 for residents to fund community-based initiatives. Over £6,000 has been given out in grants so far, and over 1,500 people have benefited from the initiative. Some of the groups who have taken advantage of the Chest have included:

- Parkley Women's Group
- Chinese Project
- Pop-in Parlour
- Bexley Business Academy
- Church of the Cross
- Black History Month

Audio X

The Audio X project was launched in September 2002 by Gallions and Trust Thamesmead and is managed by In-volve. The scheme gives young people the chance to work with the latest music production software. So far over 45 young people aged between 16 and 25 have accessed the project, working towards a London Open College Network qualification. The drop-in centre has also proved highly successful with over 160 people attending training sessions.

Work experience placements

Working with Greenwich Local Labour and Business and Access to Employment, Gallions has set up a range of opportunities for local unemployed people including a special needs placement within our Corporate Services Department.



Trees for Thamesmead

The Trees for Thamesmead programme has planted over 7000 trees in Thamesmead and carried out two successful community planting days, involving many members of the local community.

Southmere Lake clean-up

Along with Team Gallions, pupils from Southlake Primary School volunteered to help us clear the lake of rubbish. Over two tons of rubbish was removed along with garden furniture, parking cones and three safes! As well as the physical clean-up, the aim of the project was to encourage young children to think about how discarded rubbish affects the environment.

After school homework club

We are working in partnership with local schools to implement an After School Homework Club, with the aim of raising the attainment level of primary school children and easing the transition from primary to secondary school. The project consists of one hour of tuition and one hour of physical activity.

Ecopark

To help children learn about Environmental sustainability and Ecopark, Gallions worked with St John Fisher and Linton Mead schools. The children took part in an entertaining and active presentation to explain environmental sustainability in an easily understandable way.

Meet your neighbour

We have set up 'Meet Your Neighbour' sessions for prospective tenants who want to find out more about their new homes and why they were built. The sessions also provide information about tenant participation, energy saving, recycling and give people a chance to get to know their new neighbours.



Team
Gallons

Respecting the Environment

Team Gallions has continued to improve its services and maintain Thamesmead's exceptional environment. The last year has been a busy one for them, with the implementation of the first Environmental Strategy for Thamesmead. The strategy, which was developed in close consultation with residents, sets out a series of objectives for the Team. The strategy will be reviewed annually and our performance gauged against it. The discussions with residents made it clear that each type of accommodation required a different service, and Team Gallions has now produced detailed service standards tailored for residents; in tower blocks, linear blocks and houses.

Round the clock service

Our staff now provide a 365-day service that meets the needs of the local community. This is in response to residents' concerns about cleanliness over the holiday periods such as Christmas and Easter.

More facilities and equipment

A new fleet of vehicles and equipment has been introduced, including tippers for bulk rubbish removal, ride-on machines and a sophisticated Schmidt Swingo road sweeping machine.

A cleaner Thamesmead

Last summer we reached an agreement with the London Borough of Greenwich on the application of the CleanSweep project in Thamesmead and we have agreed consistent standards for the area and joint working practices.

Thamesmead in Bloom

March saw the re-implementation of the Thamesmead in Bloom Garden competition, highlighting how private space can effect the wider streetscape of Thamesmead.

CUBIT

Cubit involves partnership working between Bexley or Greenwich (depending on the area), the Metropolitan Police, DVLA and Gallions. Our Neighbourhood Wardens carry out preliminary work identifying abandoned and dangerous vehicles in a designated area that is then blocked off while immediate removal is organised. Typically this can involve the removal of 80 vehicles within one area over a two-day period. This has proved a very popular event with residents.

It's no coincidence that our environment staff are consistently rated highly by residents in our resident surveys. Our decision to take our environmental services back in house has paid dividends, and with a comprehensive staff training program in place, Team Gallions continues to provide residents with a unique and personal service.



Regenerating Thamesmead

Much has been said about Thamesmead in the past, but in looking to the future this key area of the Thames Gateway is poised for the kind of urban renewal that will allow it to shine once more.

Tavy Bridge Project

During 2001/2, Gallions developed proposals for the limited alteration of Tavy Bridge.

Development consultants Llewelyn Davies have now produced a series of remodelling and development options. These will lead to a proposal that can address all the problems of the area, and are viable in both regeneration and financial terms. These plans are now being discussed with the local community and other key stakeholders.

In the new Tavy Bridge, we plan to increase the overall number of homes, and improve the proportion of home ownership by adding 450 new homes for sub market rent, shared ownership and outright sale. We will also be facilitating a brand new health centre with modern facilities, bringing in a local police station and other public facilities such as a library.

New Build

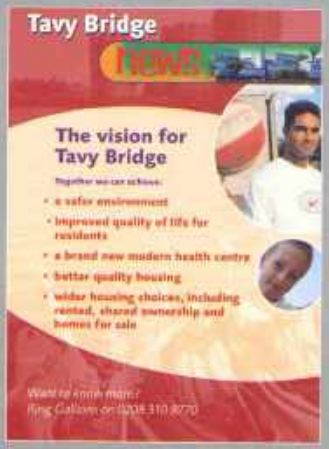
In December last year, 38 units for affordable rent were completed and handed over at Gunnery Fields. The scheme includes new homes ranging from one bedroom flats up to four bedroom houses, and has proved very popular, being located adjacent to the river in an area of increased development activity.

This was followed a few months later by the fifth phase of housing in the Gallions Reach Urban Village. This included 32 houses for affordable rent, including three 3-storey town houses specially designed with lifts for disabled residents.

2002/3 also saw Gallions receive its first allocation of funding from the Housing Corporation for the development of 30 units of affordable housing at Collingtree Park near the town centre. The sum of over £2.2m enabled us to start work in January, at which time the Housing Corporation announced a further £3.5m for the second phase of 40 units in 2003/4.

At the end of the year, our first six flats built for shared ownership were about to be handed over at Paradise Path. This new area of development for the Association provides homes for those who want to get a foot on the home ownership ladder but find current house prices too high.





Sustaining the Future

Gallions has a clear vision for the future. As part of a 1500-home 'urban village', we have built Ecopark, a test bed for environmentally friendly, low-rise social housing.

The multi-award winning Gallions Ecopark, our pioneering project in sustainable development, was launched on 29 November 2002. Using a combination of energy and water-saving features, the 39 houses for affordable rent in the Dutch-inspired project have been designed in accordance with best practice and industry excellence.

John Austin MP and local councillors from the London Boroughs of Greenwich and Bexley attended the launch day along with the press, industry professionals and future residents. Television presenter Tony Robinson also made a special appearance and directed an interesting and entertaining presentation about sustainability with local school children from St John Fisher and Linton Mead schools.

Since the opening of the Ecopark Visitors' Centre and accompanying naked house exhibition, over 300 people have visited the project to learn about sustainable development and the importance of environmental conservation. The main focus of Ecopark is to provide a demonstration of practical, everyday cost-effective construction that could easily find its way into mainstream housing projects. The Visitors' Centre and naked house aim to provide the resources for raising awareness of conservation issues, not only in the housing industry, but also within local and national government, academic and professional circles and also among our favourite visitors, children.

Over the next 12 months we will be undertaking an extensive monitoring campaign focusing on both the scientific and human side of living at Ecopark. This research is being sponsored by the Housing Corporation. Once complete, the information will be collated and integrated into a report evaluating the success of the project. This information will be available to the public and included on the Ecopark website at www.gallionsecopark.co.uk

All 39 houses within Ecopark will be contributing to the human monitoring strategy, which will incorporate a face-to-face interview and accompanying questionnaire. The information we hope to gather through this type of monitoring includes:

- Expectations before moving into the properties
- Views and experiences of living in the homes
- How residents use the innovative features included in the houses
- The impact the homes have had on residents' lives i.e. running costs/bills, comfort, convenience, health and well being, safety and security

Ecopark awards 2002 – 2003

- Demonstration Project Status by the Housing Forum
- 'Excellent' rating from the Building Research Establishment's EcoHomes Assessment Panel
- Commendation Award under the category of Innovation from the Affordable Home Ownership Awards





Performance Indicators

Stock

Gallions owned 4,535 units at the end of 2002/03, compared to 4,484 at the end of the previous year. During the year 100 newly built properties were handed over and there were 48 Right to Buy (RTB) sales, which gave a net increase in stock of 52 units.

The makeup of stock remained much the same as earlier years:



Bedsits	90	2%
One bed units	1807	40%
Two bed units	1043	23%
Three bed units	1028	23%
Four bed and larger units	568	12%

44% of stock is located in Greenwich Council area and 56% in Bexley Council area.

Rent

Rent levels are now governed by the Housing Corporation's 'Rent Restructuring' regime. These rents are known as 'target rents', and housing associations are expected to conform to these rent levels by 2011. Target rents are increased annually by RPI + 0.5%, or as may be advised differently by the Housing Corporation. Where an association's rents are below target rents, they may be increased annually as above plus a maximum of £2 per week until such time as they reach the target levels.

We have have two rent regimes – secure (fair rent) and assured. The majority of assured rents exceed target rent levels, and there is little scope to increase these until 2007 when we expect them to start reaching the projected target rent levels. Secure rents however, are in general lower than target rents, but increases are restricted not only by the Housing Corporation's guidelines outlined above, but also by the maximum rent levels registered by the Rent Officer.

Based on the above restrictions, rent increases for 2002/03 were limited to secure tenancies, which account for 39% of all tenancies, and these increases represented an average of £3.01 per week, or 5.81%.

The rent roll for the year was £17.4 million, an increase of £195,000 compared to last year. The overall rental income was made up as follows:



Rent	89%
Service charges	9%
Garage charges	2%
Miscellaneous other charges	1%

Rent arrears

Gallions' policy of vigorously pursuing rent arrears resulted in a significant improvement during the year. Gross rent arrears as at year-end were £945,000 compared to £1,001,000 last year, a reduction of 5.5%. More significantly, however, arrears as a percentage of rent debit fell from 5.99% last year to 5.42% this year, a reduction of 9.5%. Outstanding housing benefit represents a significant part of rent arrears, with payments, being very erratic. After taking into account the estimated value of outstanding benefit payments, the net rent arrears figure at year end was 3.81%, compared to 4.38% last year, an improvement of 13%.

During the year 55 tenants were evicted, compared to 48 last year. Due to early action the average eviction debt fell from £3,383 last year to £2,960, equivalent to a 12.5% reduction.

Waiting list

The number of applicants on the waiting list at year-end was 447 compared to 579 last year. These are broken down as follows:



121 External applicants	27%
277 Internal transfers	62%
49 Thamesmead residents	11%

Lettings

During the year there were 502 new lettings compared to 422 last year. This increase can be attributed to the number of new units brought into the housing stock. Applicants re-housed are broken down as follows.



External applicants	151	30%
Internal transfers / exchanges	130	26%
LA Nominations	207	41%
HOME nominations	8	1.5%
Other	6	1.5%

Empty Properties

The average number of properties empty each month (excluding new builds) fell from 39 last year to 37 this year, a reduction of 5%. In terms of empty properties as a percent of stock the figure fell from 0.87% to 0.81%, a reduction of 7%.

The average re-let period for empty properties showed a significant improvement from 5.56 weeks last year to 3.88 weeks this year, a reduction of 12%.

The reduction in the number of empty properties and the improved turn-round resulted in a small reduction in the void rent loss, from 1.31% last year to 1.29% this year. If the initial new build 'void' period were discounted, the void rent figure for this year would fall to 1.08%.

Equal Opportunities

During the year 35% of applicants re-housed (excluding nominations) were from BME households. For nominations, over which we have no direct control, the figure was 26%. The combined figure for all BME groups re-housed is 28%, which is well within the known BME representation for current tenancies.

Repairs

During the year, close on 18,000 repairs were completed at a cost of nearly £2 million. In the second half of the year Gallions entered into a partnership with Axis Europe to carry out all reactive maintenance works, except for a number of specialist trades, replacing a number of smaller contracts with local contractors.

Repair completion performance also improved in the second half of the year and saw the overall completion rate within target rise to 96% compared to 90% at the end of the last year. Performance can be broken down as follows.

Emergency repairs	98%
Urgent repairs	95%
Routine Repairs	95%
Overall	96%

Planned Maintenance

Over £2 million was spent in the year on a number planned maintenance projects. Some of the projects undertaken were:

Lighting	£ 94K
CCTV	£ 63K
Domestic Wiring	£139K
New kitchens	£125K
External decorations	£598K
Drains & sewers	£341K
Gas servicing	£412K
Environmental paving & signage	£ 38K
Asbestos removal	£ 30K

INCOME AND EXPENDITURE ACCOUNT for the year ended 31 MARCH 2003

	Group		Association	
	2003	2002	2003	2002
	£000	£000	£000	£000
Turnover				
Group and share of joint venture	34,799	31,376	19,803	19,501
Less: Share of joint venture turnover – Tilfen	(14,996)	(11,825)	–	–
Group turnover	19,803	19,551	19,803	19,501
Operating costs	(18,486)	(17,399)	(18,486)	(17,307)
Operating surplus	1,317	2,152	1,317	2,194
Share of operating surplus in joint venture	6,956	4,517	–	–
Total operating surplus including share of joint venture	8,273	6,669	1,317	2,194
Surplus on sale of fixed assets	1,309	708	1,309	708
Surplus on ordinary activities before interest	9,582	7,377	2,626	2,902
Interest receivable	229	696	97	517
Interest payable	(733)	(1,066)	(733)	(1,066)
Surplus on ordinary activities before taxation	9,078	7,007	1,990	2,353
Taxation (charge)/credit on surplus on ordinary activities – share of tax of joint venture	67	(91)	–	–
Retained surplus for the period	9,143	6,916	1,990	2,353

The operating surplus for the year arises from continuing operations of the group and Association.

BALANCE SHEET as at 31 MARCH 2003

	Group		Association	
	2003 £000	2002 £000	2003 £000	2002 £000
Fixed assets				
Housing properties at cost less depreciation	94,504	87,220	94,504	87,220
Other tangible assets	3,481	3,409	3,481	3,363
Investments	–	–	20,439	20,504
Investments in joint venture				
Share of gross assets	47,412	35,660	–	–
Share of gross liabilities	(8,888)	(6,429)	–	–
	136,509	119,860	118,424	111,087
Current assets				
Debtors	1,929	1,481	1,929	1,514
Cash at bank and in hand	1	8,465	1	8,454
	1,930	9,946	1,930	9,968
Creditors: amounts falling due within one year	(4,682)	(6,236)	(4,682)	(6,244)
Net current assets	(2,752)	3,710	(2,752)	3,724
Total assets less current liabilities	133,757	123,570	115,672	114,811
Creditors: amounts falling due after more than one year	13,600	14,300	13,600	14,300
Provision for liabilities and charges	1,809	2,239	1,809	2,239
Capital and reserves				
Share capital	–	–	–	–
Revenue reserves	25,508	14,794	10,852	7,327
Revaluation reserve	3,429	1,292	–	–
Negative goodwill	89,411	90,945	89,411	90,945
	133,757	123,570	115,672	114,811

Approved by the Management Board on 6 August 2003

Graham Horton, Chairman of the board

Averyl Richards, Secretary

Ibironke Adeagbo, Treasurer/Member of the board

Board Information

MANAGEMENT BOARD AS AT 31 MARCH 2003

Tenants and Charge-payers

Tokky Ademoyero
Graham Horton
Freda McEwen
Ken Sealey

Local Authority Nominees

Manny Blake
Harbans Buttar
Peter Kotz
John Wakefield

Independent Board Members

Ronke Adeagbo
William Ekinu
Chris Garlick
Keith Wrate

BOARD MEMBER ATTENDANCE



Local Authority	57%
Tenants/Chargepayers	90%
Independents	72%
Total	77%

BOARD AND COMMITTEE STRUCTURE

The Board operates a governance structure of four Committees – Audit, Finance, Operations and Urgency. Each Committee's brief is to scrutinise in detail the policy and performance issues within its scope. Board members with the appropriate skills and experience are members of each of the Committees. In order to secure wider engagement of Board members, a system of Board "champions" for particular subjects or areas, and one-off short-lived working groups for particular subjects, is operated. The structure of the Committees is shown above.

Gallions Board Structure

- Audit Committee
- Finance, Risk and Development Committee
- Operations Committee
- Urgency Committee

OBLIGATIONS OF BOARD MEMBERS

A Board member's obligations include:

- to uphold the Association's core policies, including those for equality and diversity
- to uphold the values and objectives of the Association
- to contribute to a shared responsibility for the Board's decisions
- to prepare for and attend meetings, training and other events of the Association
- to represent the Association on occasions
- to declare any relevant interests
- to respect confidentiality of information
- to uphold the National Federation of Housing Associations' Code of Governance

No individual can stand for, or remain a member of, the Association or Board if they have arrears or any other dispute with the Association, unless they have entered into a satisfactory arrangement for clearing those arrears or resolving the dispute.

SKILLS, QUALITIES AND EXPERIENCE REQUIRED OF BOARD MEMBERS

It is of key importance that the Board ensures that its members have the skills, knowledge and experience to enable them to carry out their responsibilities effectively. The recruitment, induction and training of Board members are crucial elements in ensuring the sound governance of the Association.

The Board will ensure that new members are recruited or elected on a systematic and continuous basis and, wherever possible, by open advertisement or by consultation with other interested bodies. Members recruited should have relevant skills and experience and the Board as a whole will seek to reflect the communities within which it works.

The Board also considers the balance of skills and experience that is appropriate to its work, and recruits Board members openly and systematically so as to achieve this balance. At least once each year, the Board identifies any skills which will be required amongst its membership in order to satisfactorily discharge its responsibilities.

The table below shows the skills, qualities and experience that Board members are required to have, and the extent to which they are met by existing Board members currently in office and those members retiring who are intending to re-offer themselves for election. These criteria are laid down by both the Housing Corporation and the Charities Commission, and Gallions must comply with these legal requirements:

	Little knowledge/ experience	General knowledge/ experience	High level of knowledge/ experience
The housing needs that the RSL aims to meet	9%	79%	18%
Residents' needs and concerns	0%	73%	27%
Strategic management in a public or private body	18%	45%	38%
General business activities including the management of staff, property and contracts	9%	45%	45%
Finance	9%	73%	18%
Legal matters	27%	64%	9%
Community relations and needs, including equal opportunities	0%	73%	27%
Working with local authorities	9%	27%	64%
Development and building	45%	36%	18%
Public relations	9%	82%	9%
Management of information technology	45%	36%	18%
Race equality	0%	55%	45%

METHOD OF ELECTION FOR TENANT AND CHARGE-PAYER BOARD MEMBERS

Tenant and Charge-payer Board members shall be drawn from members of Gallions Residents Board who have been elected by the tenants/charge-payers of the Association respectively and are proposed for consideration to the Board by the Executive of the GRB.

Any candidate for election to the Board is required to submit a written statement to the Association setting out the reasons for their suitability to be a Board member.

COMPLIANCE WITH THE NHF CODE OF GOVERNANCE

Gallions complies with the National Housing Federation's 2000 Code of Governance 'Competence and Accountability'.

EXECUTIVE TEAM

Chief Executive **Tony Cotter**

Director of Resources	Director of Development and Regeneration	Director of Operations (Acting)
Fred Angole	**Sue Chalkley**	**Sharon McGregor**

SHAREHOLDING MEMBERSHIP POLICY

Gallions is committed to maintaining a broadly based shareholding membership as a means of ensuring openness and accountability, and to encourage greater resident involvement in the management of their homes.

All applications for membership of the Association should meet at least one of the following criteria:

- The applicant has a long-term interest in and support for the Association.
- The applicant has the appropriate skills, experience and availability to make a significant contribution to the Association by becoming a member, either at the time of application or in the future, if not –
- The applicant has the commitment and relevant skills and/or experience to make a positive contribution to the Association without becoming an active member.
- The applicant will help improve the representation of local communities within the Association's shareholding.
- The applicant will contribute to achieving a balanced mix within the Association's shareholding.



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